

“Companies are finally using open source for the greater good”

Pradeep Balachandran, keynote speaker on Day Two of Open Source India 2018 and **Program Director** at **IBM**, speaks with **Dilin Anand** from **OSFY** about his personal views on the evolution of open source.

Q If we were to consider the journey of open source till now, what stage are we at right now?

We are at a point in time that marks the second coming for open source. Why? Open source is now mainstream. We are in an interesting era where there is a lot more adoption of open source. Companies are finally using open source for the greater good and to innovate at scale.

Q What do you believe was the trigger for this second coming?

Technology is changing faster than ever before. For businesses, this means, they need to adopt the latest technologies faster to stay relevant in the market. How do they do this? They need to partner with others; the natural choice is to partner with open source communities. With open source, the whole is larger than the sum of its parts.

Q How about an example to prove that point?

Kubernetes is a recent example where various organisations came together to take it forward under the Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF). CNCF was formed with Kubernetes as the first project, and now hosts many projects that are building blocks of the cloud native software stack.

Q What kept businesses from tapping this potential of open source?

There used to be a misconception – that it is too risky to build on top of open source technology. The truth is that risk always exists irrespective of whether the technology is proprietary or open. With open source, the technology remains open and as long as there are enough contributors, the project will live on.

